

# Guitar Harmony

Music theory and chord progressions for guitarists

Circle of fifths · chord functions · 12 major + 12 minor keys · chord diagrams · barre & capo

- 1 Tones, semitones & chord building** the chromatic scale · major & minor scales · stacked thirds (p. 2)
- 2 Chord functions & the circle** I/IV/V/vi · cadences · why the circle works (p. 3)
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- 4 Major keys** C · G · D · A · E · B · F<sup>♯</sup> · D<sup>b</sup> · A<sup>b</sup> · E<sup>b</sup> · B<sup>b</sup> · F (p. 5–16)
- 5 Minor keys** a · e · b · f<sup>♯</sup> · c<sup>♯</sup> · g<sup>♯</sup> · d<sup>♯</sup> · b<sup>b</sup> · f · c · g · d (p. 17–28)

Repo and edits: [github.com/Vilda007/kytara-harmonicke-postupy](https://github.com/Vilda007/kytara-harmonicke-postupy) — generators `kytara-gen.py` (major), `kytara-gen-moll.py` (minor), `kytara-gen-book.py` (book), `kytara-gen-book-en.py` (EN book).

MIT licence (LICENSE). Diagrams optimized for A4 print; colors = chord functions (green tonic, ochre subdominant, red dominant, blue minor).

# Tones, semitones & chord building

## The chromatic scale (12 tones) and the major scale

major scale = 7 steps, W = whole step, H = half step

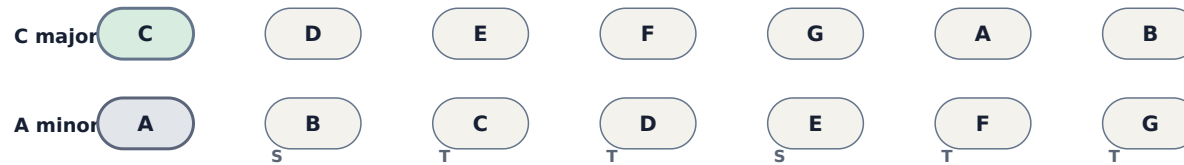


The major scale = whole-whole-half-whole-whole-whole-half (from C: the white piano keys). An octave = 12 semitones = the same tone up.

A key = the same tones transposed anywhere (the pattern holds): G major = one sharp (F#) only, D major = F# + C#, etc.

On the guitar a semitone = one fret; a whole step = two frets. The #/b signs shift a tone by a half step.

## Major vs. minor — same tones, different home

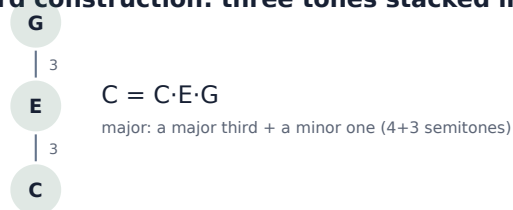


A minor = the RELATIVE MINOR of C major: the same seven tones, but tonic = A. The minor pattern: whole-half-whole-whole-half-whole-whole.

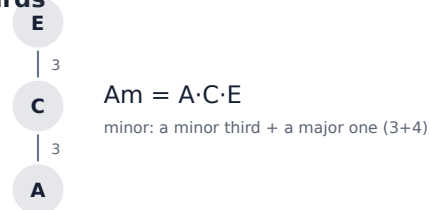
In sound: major = bright/open, minor = darker; the difference is not the tones but where the song calls home.

A note on names: Czech tradition says H where we say B natural (B<sub>n</sub> = their B). The repo diagrams keep international names (B, B<sub>n</sub>).

## Chord construction: three tones stacked in thirds



major: a major third + a minor one (4+3 semitones)



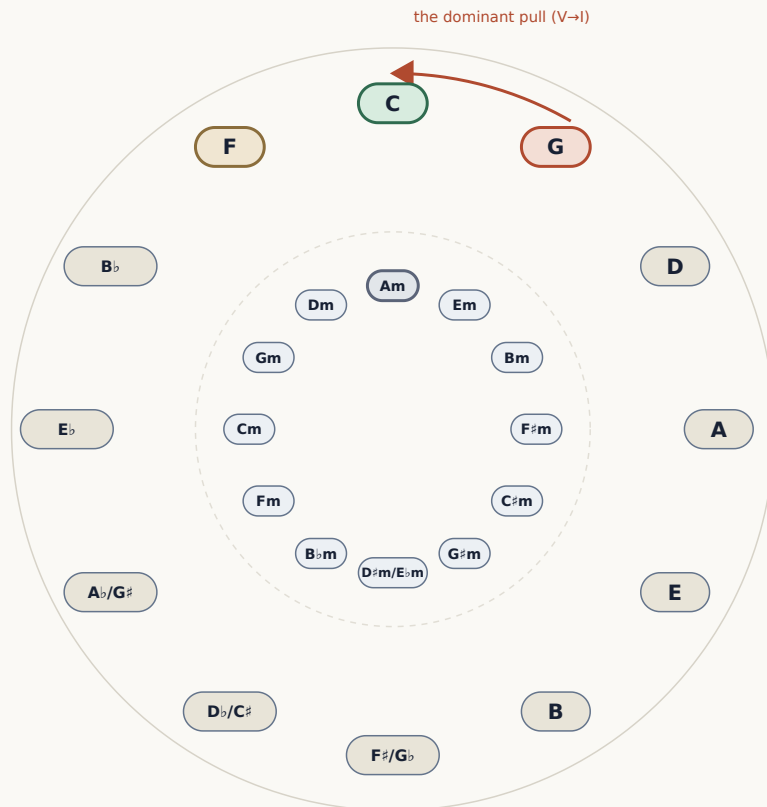
minor: a minor third + a major one (3+4)



dim: two minor thirds (3+3) — tense, doubly flat

A seventh = add one more third (C7 = C · E · G · B<sub>n</sub>) — very common in blues. A chord is named after its lowest tone (its root).

# Chord functions & the circle



The C major example: V (G) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (F) on the left, vi (Am) inside the ring — the whole circle works identically for every key.

**Why the circle works: clockwise = a fifth (7), counterclockwise = a fourth (5).**

Each clockwise step adds one #, counterclockwise drops one b.

Sharps: F# C# G# D# A# E# B# · flats: Bb Eb Ab Db Gb Cb Fb.

Circle of fifths = a map of relations: V = home, IV = look around, vi = sadness, III = escape.

## Functions = chord roles inside a key

|                    |                       |                                         |
|--------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| <b>I</b>           | <b>tonic</b>          | home, rest — the song rests on it       |
| <b>IV</b>          | <b>subdominant</b>    | moving away — opens up, a fresh breath  |
| <b>V</b>           | <b>dominant</b>       | tension — pulls back to the tonic (V→I) |
| <b>vi</b>          | <b>relative minor</b> | a second home — colours the song minor  |
| <b>ii·iii·vii°</b> | <b>a side role</b>    | bridges, colors, turnarounds            |

## Cadences — typical pulls (in C major)

|                   |            |                     |
|-------------------|------------|---------------------|
| <b>V → I</b>      | G → C      | the firm resolution |
| <b>IV → I</b>     | F → C      | the plagal "Amen"   |
| <b>ii - V - I</b> | Dm - G → C | a jazz turnaround   |

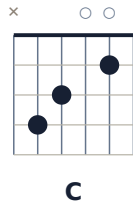
## Minor roles (in A minor)

|                               |                                    |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <b>i tonic</b>                | the home (Am)                      |
| <b>iv + VI</b>                | the subdominant (Dm, F)            |
| <b>v minor dominant</b>       | soft: Em — it glides, no push      |
| <b>V7, the sharp dominant</b> | E7 = E-G#-B-D: G# = the raised 7th |
| <b>III, the major sibling</b> | the "escape door" (C)              |

**HARMONIC MINOR = a raised 7th (the 7th degree; A minor: G→G#) — the dominant rises from v (Em) to V7 (E7) and the v→i pull then sounds like a major V→I. Skip ii° (Bdim) on guitar — iv (Dm) fills in fine.**

# Fretboard practice — diagrams, barre, capo and transposing progressions

## How to read the chord diagrams



the thick top line = fret 0 (the nut)

x = don't pluck, o = open string

a dot = a fingertip; the columns = strings

**E A D G B e (left = lowest → highest)**

on barres: the left number = the starting fret

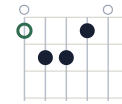
Notes on the guitar: every fret = a semitone. Open strings: E(6th) A(5th) D(4th) G(3rd) B(2nd) e(1st).

A chord = 3-5 strings at once; a muted string (x) just stays dead — the rest ringing is fine.

The diagrams keep international names (B, B<sup>b</sup>); Czech players often say H for B natural.

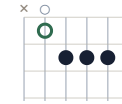
A barre = one finger across all strings → one shape anywhere on the neck.

## Barre shapes and the capo



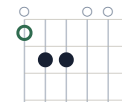
**E major**

F=1·G=3·A=5·B=7·C=8·D=10  
tonic on string 6



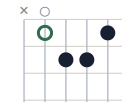
**A major**

B=2·C=3·D=5·E=7·F=8  
tonic on string 5



**Em minor**

F#m=2·Gm=3·Am=5·Bm=7  
tonic on string 6



**Am minor**

Bm=2·Cm=3·Dm=5·Em=7  
tonic on string 5

**CAPO = the clamp: it shortens all strings at fret N → easy-key shapes play N semitones up.**

Easy major shapes: C · G · D · A · E — easy minor shapes: Am · Em. Everything else = the same shapes + a capo.

Choosing: the nearest easy key = fewer barre frets (e.g. B<sup>b</sup> minor: capo 1 + A-minor shapes).

## Transposing a progression into any key — step by step

- 1 Pick a progression** e.g. the pop four-chord I-V-vi-IV
- 2 Find the tonic on the circle** your target key (anywhere on the circle)
- 3 Read the neighbourhood** V = clockwise, IV = counterclockwise, vi = the inner chip below the tonic
- 4 Rewrite the chords** the same romans, new names
- 5 Pick shapes or a capo** easy-key open shapes + a capo, or a barre

**Example: the four-chord I-V-vi-IV in E major (C → E = shifted 4 semitones): E - B - C<sup>#</sup>m - A; the easy route: capo 4 + C-major shapes.**

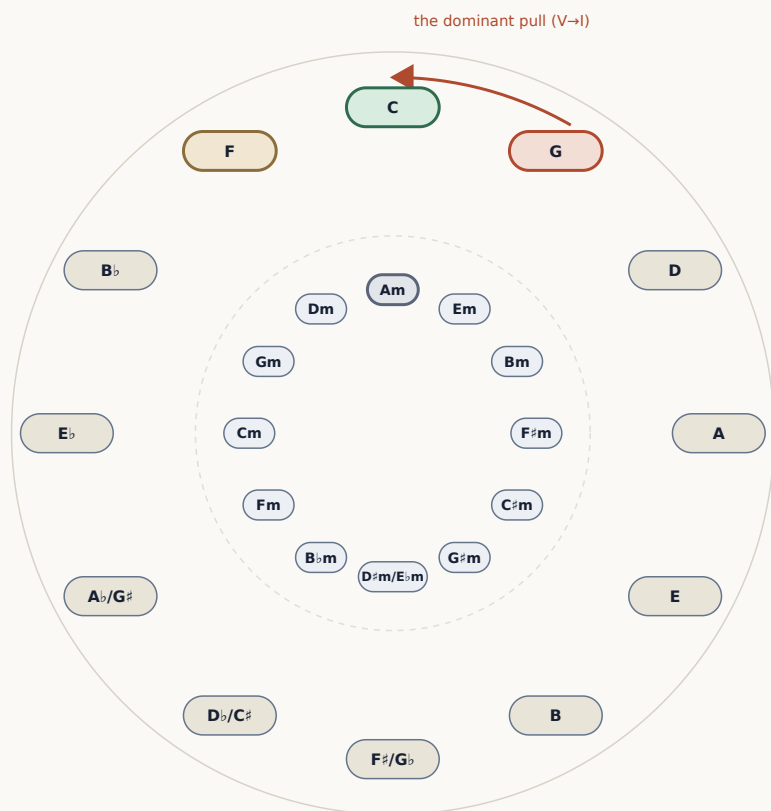
Minor-key tricks: ii° → replace with iv · v → V7 (harmonic minor, raised 7th) · the Andalusian cadence i-VII-VI-V = a minor descent from home.

Blues (12 bars): major: I×4-IV×2-I×2-V-IV-I-V · minor: i×4-iv×2-i×2-V7-iv-i-V7 (V7 = the raised 7th).

Play the progressions slowly at 60 BPM and change chords on the beat. Colours in the diagrams = chord functions → your eyes find them fast.

# Chord progressions in C major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

## Diatonic chords in C major

| I · C<br>tonic | ii · Dm<br>subdom. | iii · Em<br>linking | IV · F<br>subdom. | V · G<br>dominant | vi · Am<br>rel. minor | vii° · Bdim<br>side                                        |
|----------------|--------------------|---------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| x ○ ○          | x x ○              | ○ ○ ○ ○             | ○ ○ ○ ○           | ○ ○ ○             | x ○ ○                 | x ○ ○                                                      |
|                |                    |                     |                   |                   |                       |                                                            |
| C<br>I · tonic | Dm<br>ii · subdom. | Em<br>iii · linking | F<br>IV · subdom. | G<br>V · dominant | Am<br>vi · rel. minor | Bdim<br>vii° · skip it<br>pull substitute:<br>B7<br>x21202 |

Notation: ○ = open string, x = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in C major)

I - IV - V

C - F - G

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

C - G - Am - F

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

Am - F - C - G

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

C - Am - F - G

doo-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

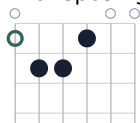
Dm - G - C

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

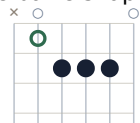
|    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|
| C7 | C7 | C7 | C7 | F7 | F7 | C7 | C7 | G7 | F7 | C7 | G7 |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|

## Transposing on the guitar: one barre shape, any key



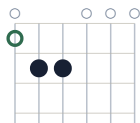
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



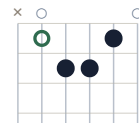
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

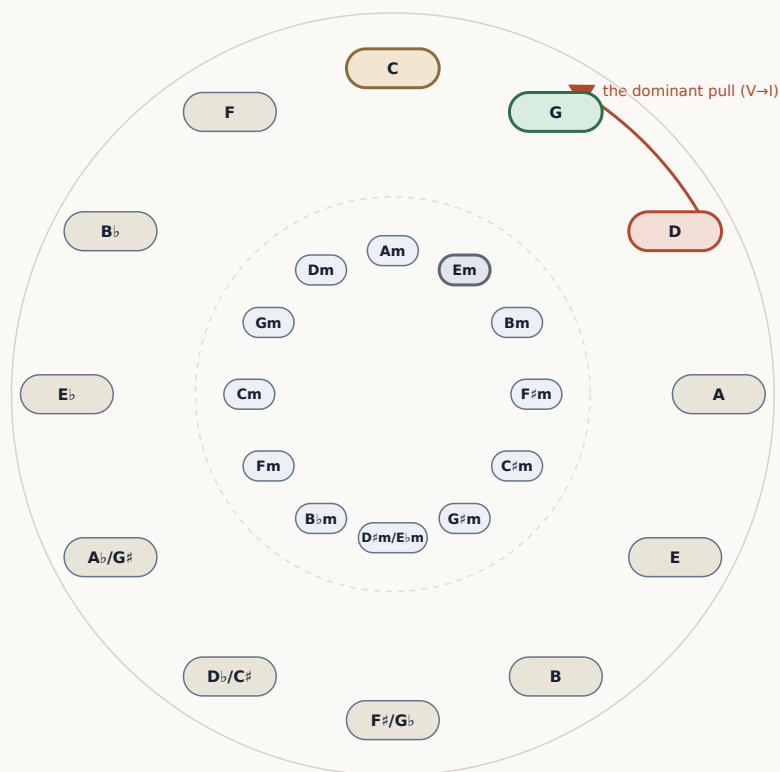
Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

**How to read it: a barre = one finger across all strings,** at the chosen fret — the shape stays, only the position changes. The green ring marks where the tonic sits (the chord's name). Progressions work in ANY key — you shift them along the circle of fifths: e.g. C-G-Am-F → G major: G-D-Em-C (a 7-fret shift).

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**  
The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

# Chord progressions in G major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

## Diatonic chords in G major

| I · G<br>tonic | ii · Am<br>subdom. | iii · Bm<br>linking | IV · C<br>subdom. | V · D<br>dominant | vi · Em<br>rel. minor | vii° · F#dim<br>side |
|----------------|--------------------|---------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-----------------------|----------------------|
| ○ ○ ○          | × ○ ○ ○            | ○ ×                 | × ○ ○ ○           | × × ○             | ○ ○ ○ ○               |                      |
|                |                    |                     |                   |                   |                       |                      |
| G<br>I · tonic | Am<br>ii · subdom. | Bm<br>iii · linking | C<br>IV · subdom. | D<br>V · dominant | Em<br>vi · rel. minor |                      |

**F#dim**  
vii° · skip it  
pull substitute:  
**F#7**  
242322

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in G major)

|                        |                       |                                             |
|------------------------|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <b>I - IV - V</b>      | <b>G - C - D</b>      | the staple of rock and folk                 |
| <b>I - V - vi - IV</b> | <b>G - D - Em - C</b> | the pop "four-chord"                        |
| <b>vi - IV - I - V</b> | <b>Em - C - G - D</b> | the same four chords, but home in the minor |
| <b>I - vi - IV - V</b> | <b>G - Em - C - D</b> | doo-wop, the 1950s                          |
| <b>ii - V - I</b>      | <b>Am - D - G</b>     | a jazz turnaround                           |

### Blues, 12 bars:

|    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|
| G7 | G7 | G7 | G7 | C7 | C7 | G7 | G7 | D7 | C7 | G7 | D7 |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

**E major shape**  
F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6

**A major shape**  
B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5

**Em minor shape**  
F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6

**Am minor shape**  
Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

### The easiest way — the key of G:

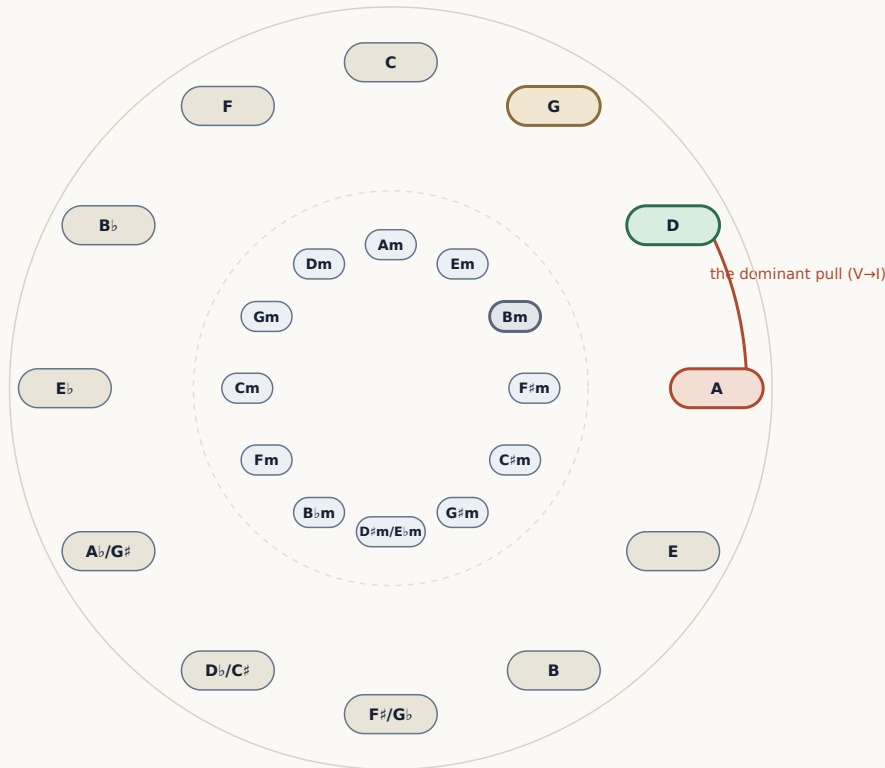
capo 2 + F major shapes  
G, Am, Bm, C, D, Em — all easy.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes  
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**  
The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

# Chord progressions in D major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



## Diatonic chords in D major

| I · D<br>tonic | ii · Em<br>subdom. | iii · F#m<br>linking | IV · G<br>subdom. | V · A<br>dominant | vi · Bm<br>rel. minor | vii° · C#dim<br>side |
|----------------|--------------------|----------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-----------------------|----------------------|
| x x o          | o o o o            | 2 x x x x x          | o o o             | x o o x           | 2 x x x x x           |                      |
|                |                    |                      |                   |                   |                       |                      |
| D<br>I · tonic | Em<br>ii · subdom. | F#m<br>iii · linking | G<br>IV · subdom. | A<br>V · dominant | Bm<br>vi · rel. minor |                      |

**C#dim**  
vii° · skip it  
pull substitute:  
**C#7**  
x46464

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in D major)

|                        |                       |                                             |
|------------------------|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| <b>I - IV - V</b>      | <b>D - G - A</b>      | the staple of rock and folk                 |
| <b>I - V - vi - IV</b> | <b>D - A - Bm - G</b> | the pop "four-chord"                        |
| <b>vi - IV - I - V</b> | <b>Bm - G - D - A</b> | the same four chords, but home in the minor |
| <b>I - vi - IV - V</b> | <b>D - Bm - G - A</b> | doo-wop, the 1950s                          |
| <b>ii - V - I</b>      | <b>Em - A - D</b>     | a jazz turnaround                           |

**Blues, 12 bars:**

|    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|
| D7 | D7 | D7 | D7 | G7 | G7 | D7 | D7 | A7 | G7 | D7 | A7 |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|

Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

|                                                                                 |                                                                          |                                                                                  |                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                                 |                                                                          |                                                                                  |                                                                                |
| <b>E major shape</b><br>F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10<br>tonic on string 6 | <b>A major shape</b><br>B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8<br>tonic on string 5 | <b>Em minor shape</b><br>F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10<br>tonic on string 6 | <b>Am minor shape</b><br>Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8<br>tonic on string 5 |

## The easiest way — the key of D:

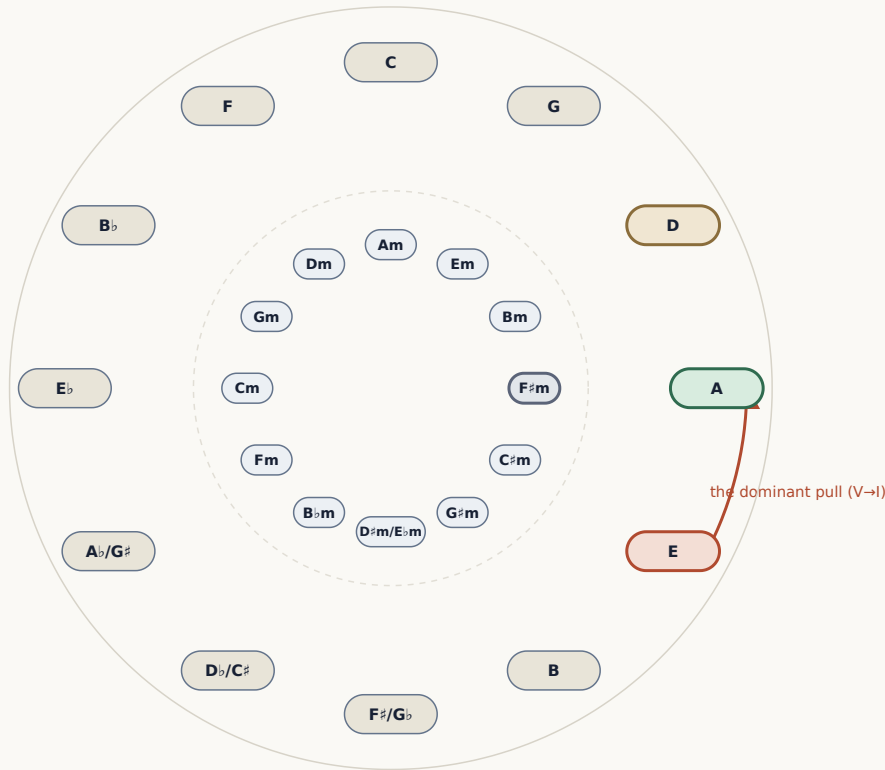
capo 2 + C major shapes  
D, Em, F#m, G, A, Bm — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**  
The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

# Chord progressions in A major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

## Diatonic chords in A major

| I · A<br>tonic | ii · Bm<br>subdom. | iii · C#m<br>linking | IV · D<br>subdom. | V · E<br>dominant | vi · F#m<br>rel. minor | vii° · G#dim<br>side |
|----------------|--------------------|----------------------|-------------------|-------------------|------------------------|----------------------|
| x ○ ○ ○ ○ ○    | x ○ ○ ○ ○ ○        | x ○ ○ ○ ○ ○          | x x ○ ○ ○ ○       | ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○       | ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○            |                      |
|                |                    |                      |                   |                   |                        |                      |
| A<br>I · tonic | Bm<br>ii · subdom. | C#m<br>iii · linking | D<br>IV · subdom. | E<br>V · dominant | F#m<br>vi · rel. minor |                      |

**G#dim**  
vii° · skip it  
pull substitute:  
**G#7**  
464544

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in A major)

**I - IV - V**

**A - D - E**

the staple of rock and folk

**I - V - vi - IV**

**A - E - F#m - D**

the pop "four-chord"

**vi - IV - I - V**

**F#m - D - A - E**

the same four chords, but home in the minor

**I - vi - IV - V**

**A - F#m - D - E**

doo-wop, the 1950s

**ii - V - I**

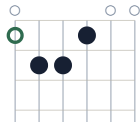
**Bm - E - A**

a jazz turnaround

**Blues, 12 bars:**

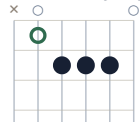
|    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|
| A7 | A7 | A7 | A7 | D7 | D7 | A7 | A7 | E7 | D7 | A7 | E7 |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



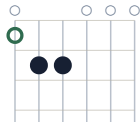
**E major shape**

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



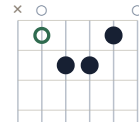
**A major shape**

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



**Em minor shape**

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



**Am minor shape**

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

## The easiest way — the key of A:

capo 2 + G major shapes

A, Bm, C#m, D, E, F#m — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

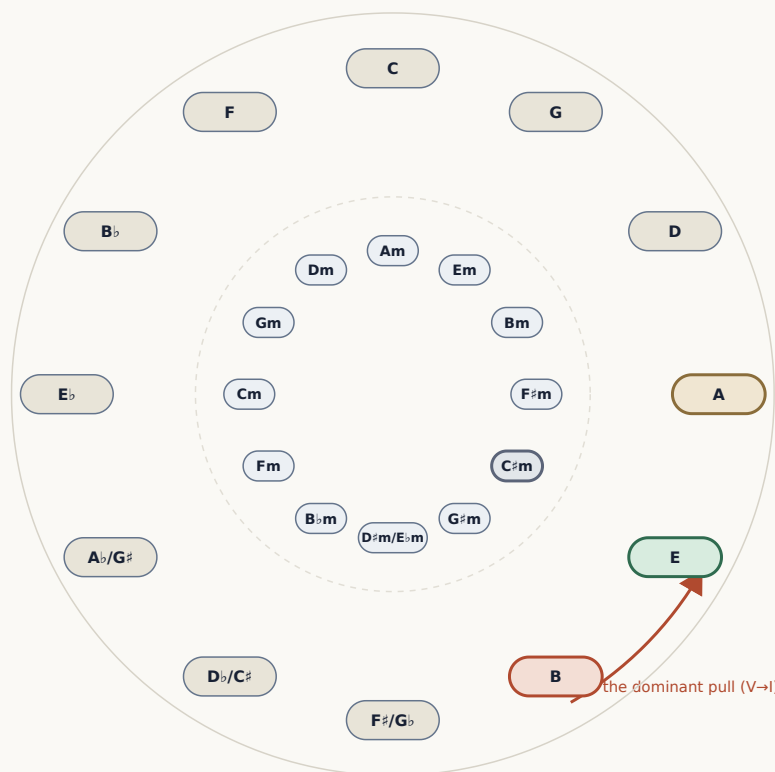
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

# Chord progressions in E major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

## Diatonic chords in E major

| I · E<br>tonic | ii · F#m<br>subdom. | iii · G#m<br>linking | IV · A<br>subdom. | V · B<br>dominant | vi · C#m<br>rel. minor | vii° · D#dim<br>side                                         |
|----------------|---------------------|----------------------|-------------------|-------------------|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
|                |                     |                      |                   |                   |                        |                                                              |
| E<br>I · tonic | F#m<br>ii · subdom. | G#m<br>iii · linking | A<br>IV · subdom. | B<br>V · dominant | C#m<br>vi · rel. minor | D#dim<br>vii° · skip it<br>pull substitute:<br>D#7<br>x68686 |

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in E major)

I - IV - V

E - A - B

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

E - B - C#m - A

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

C#m - A - E - B

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

E - C#m - A - B

doo-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

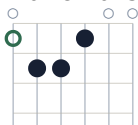
F#m - B - E

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

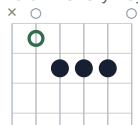
|    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|
| E7 | E7 | E7 | E7 | A7 | A7 | E7 | E7 | B7 | A7 | E7 | B7 |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



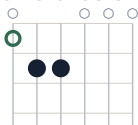
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



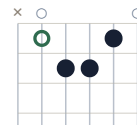
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

## The easiest way — the key of E:

capo 2 + D major shapes

E, F#m, G#m, A, B, C#m — fewer barres.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

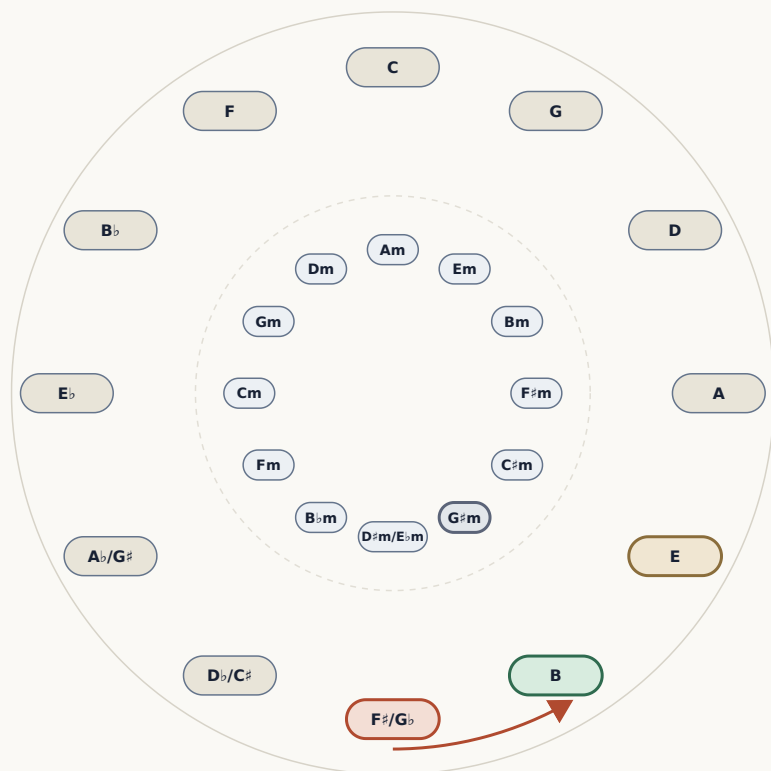
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: I tonic · IV subdominant · V dominant · vi rel. minor

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

# Chord progressions in B major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

## Diatonic chords in B major

| I · B<br>tonic | ii · C#m<br>subdom. | iii · D#m<br>linking | IV · E<br>subdom. | V · F#<br>dominant | vi · G#m<br>rel. minor | vii° · A#dim<br>side |
|----------------|---------------------|----------------------|-------------------|--------------------|------------------------|----------------------|
| x              | x                   | x                    | o o o             |                    |                        |                      |
| 2              | 4                   | 6                    |                   | 2                  | 4                      |                      |
| B<br>I · tonic | C#m<br>ii · subdom. | D#m<br>iii · linking | E<br>IV · subdom. | F#<br>V · dominant | G#m<br>vi · rel. minor |                      |

**A#dim**  
vii° · skip it  
pull substitute:  
**A#7**  
x13131

Notation: o = open string, x = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in B major)

**I - IV - V**

**B - E - F#**

the staple of rock and folk

**I - V - vi - IV**

**B - F# - G#m - E**

the pop "four-chord"

**vi - IV - I - V**

**G#m - E - B - F#**

the same four chords, but home in the minor

**I - vi - IV - V**

**B - G#m - E - F#**

doo-wop, the 1950s

**ii - V - I**

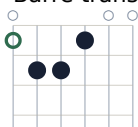
**C#m - F# - B**

a jazz turnaround

**Blues, 12 bars:**

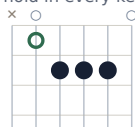
|    |    |    |    |    |    |    |    |     |    |    |     |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|-----|----|----|-----|
| B7 | B7 | B7 | B7 | E7 | E7 | B7 | B7 | F#7 | E7 | B7 | F#7 |
|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|----|-----|----|----|-----|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



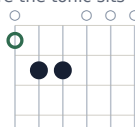
**E major shape**

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



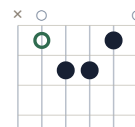
**A major shape**

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



**Em minor shape**

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



**Am minor shape**

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

## The easiest way — the key of B:

capo 2 + A major shapes

B, C#m, D#m, E, F#, G#m — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

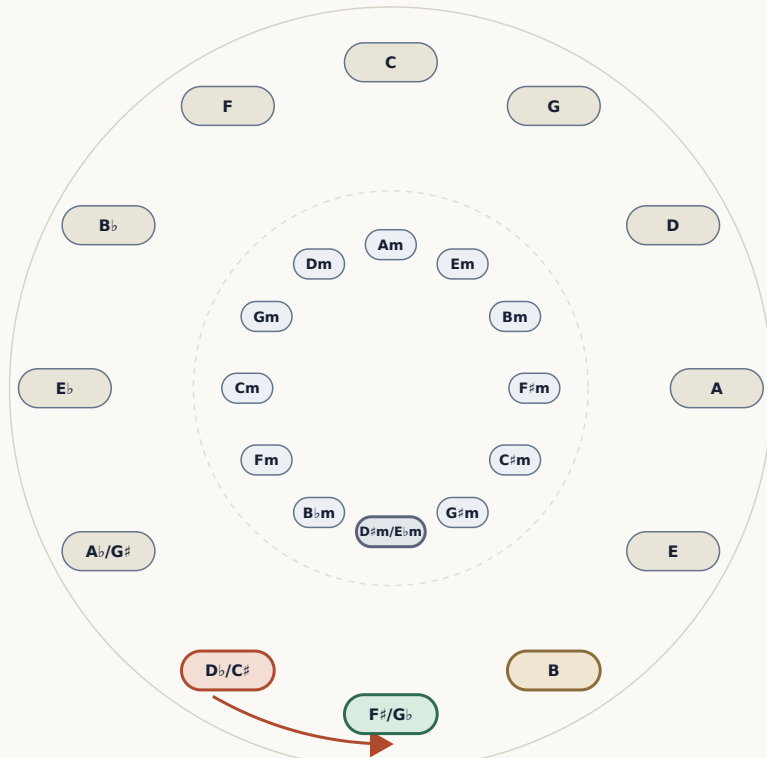
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

# Chord progressions in F# major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



the dominant pull (V-I)  
Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

## Diatonic chords in F# major

| I · F#<br>tonic | ii · G#m<br>subdom. | iii · A#m<br>linking | IV · B<br>subdom. | V · C#<br>dominant | vi · D#m<br>rel. minor | vii° · E#dim<br>side                                              |
|-----------------|---------------------|----------------------|-------------------|--------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2               | 4                   | x                    | x                 | x                  | x                      |                                                                   |
|                 |                     |                      |                   |                    |                        |                                                                   |
| F#<br>I · tonic | G#m<br>ii · subdom. | A#m<br>iii · linking | B<br>IV · subdom. | C#<br>V · dominant | D#m<br>vi · rel. minor | E#dim<br>vii° · skip it<br>pull substitute:<br>E#7 = F7<br>131211 |

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in F# major)

I - IV - V

F# - B - C#

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

F# - C# - D#m - B

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

D#m - B - F# - C#

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

F# - D#m - B - C#

doo-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

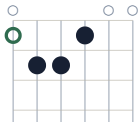
G#m - C# - F#

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

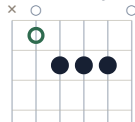
|     |     |     |     |    |    |     |     |     |    |     |     |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|----|----|-----|-----|-----|----|-----|-----|
| F#7 | F#7 | F#7 | F#7 | B7 | B7 | F#7 | F#7 | C#7 | B7 | F#7 | C#7 |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|----|----|-----|-----|-----|----|-----|-----|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



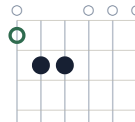
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



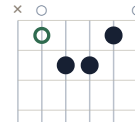
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

## The easiest way — the key of F#:

capo 2 + E major shapes

F#, G#m, A#m, B, C#, D#m — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

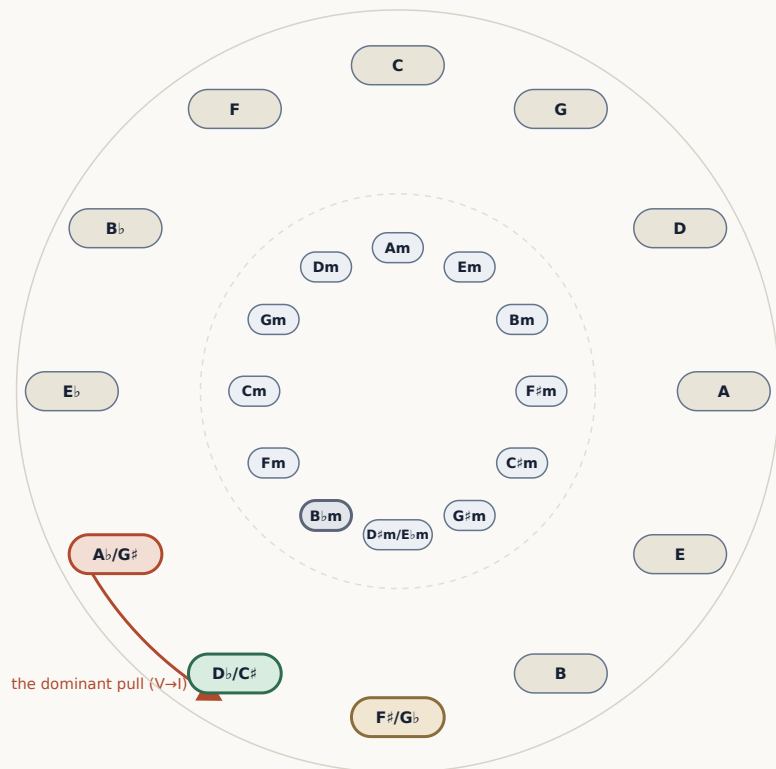
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: I tonic · IV subdominant · V dominant · vi rel. minor

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

# Chord progressions in D $\flat$ major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

## Diatonic chords in D $\flat$ major

| I · D $\flat$<br>tonic | ii · E $\flat$ m<br>subdom. | iii · Fm<br>linking | IV · G $\flat$<br>subdom. | V · A $\flat$<br>dominant | vi · B $\flat$ m<br>rel. minor | vii $^\circ$ · Cdim<br>side                                        |
|------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 9                      | 6                           | 6                   | 2                         | 4                         | 4                              |                                                                    |
| D $\flat$<br>I · tonic | E $\flat$ m<br>ii · subdom. | Fm<br>iii · linking | G $\flat$<br>IV · subdom. | A $\flat$<br>V · dominant | B $\flat$ m<br>vi · rel. minor | Cdim<br>vii $^\circ$ · skip it<br>pull substitute:<br>C7<br>x32310 |

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in D $\flat$ major)

|                 |                                                 |                                             |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| I - IV - V      | D $\flat$ - G $\flat$ - A $\flat$               | the staple of rock and folk                 |
| I - V - vi - IV | D $\flat$ - A $\flat$ - B $\flat$ m - G $\flat$ | the pop "four-chord"                        |
| vi - IV - I - V | B $\flat$ m - G $\flat$ - D $\flat$ - A $\flat$ | the same four chords, but home in the minor |
| I - vi - IV - V | D $\flat$ - B $\flat$ m - G $\flat$ - A $\flat$ | doo-wop, the 1950s                          |
| ii - V - I      | E $\flat$ m - A $\flat$ - D $\flat$             | a jazz turnaround                           |

### Blues, 12 bars:

|             |             |             |             |             |             |             |             |             |             |             |             |
|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|
| D $\flat$ 7 | D $\flat$ 7 | D $\flat$ 7 | D $\flat$ 7 | G $\flat$ 7 | G $\flat$ 7 | D $\flat$ 7 | D $\flat$ 7 | A $\flat$ 7 | G $\flat$ 7 | D $\flat$ 7 | A $\flat$ 7 |
|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10

tonic on string 6

A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8

tonic on string 5

Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10

tonic on string 6

Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8

tonic on string 5

### The easiest way — the key of D $\flat$ :

capo 1 + C major shapes

D $\flat$ , E $\flat$ m, Fm, G $\flat$ , A $\flat$ , B $\flat$ m — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

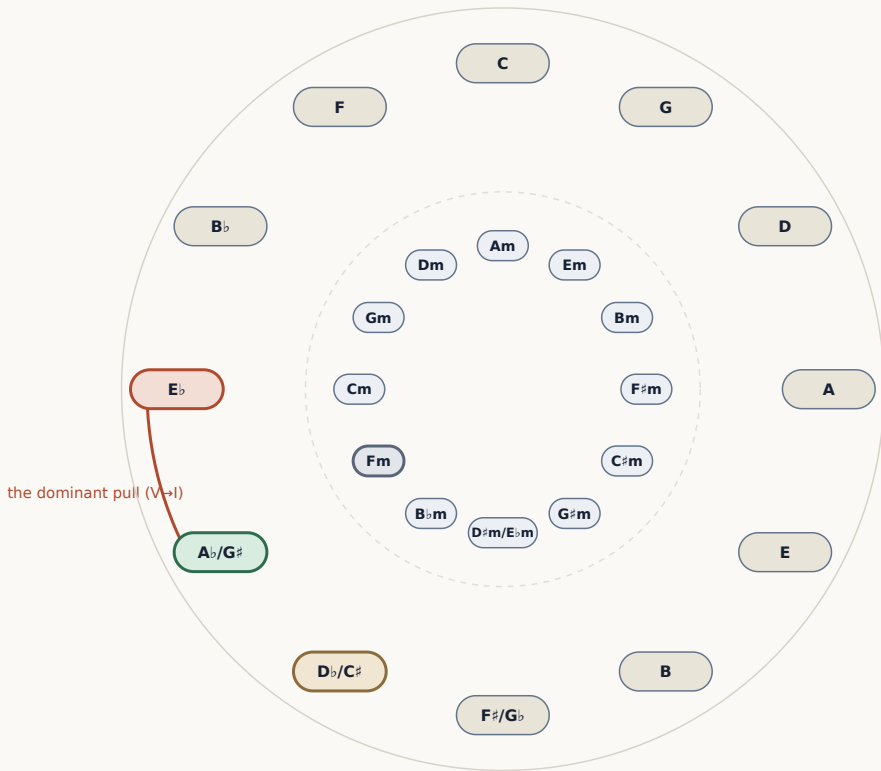
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: I tonic · IV subdominant · V dominant · vi rel. minor

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

# Chord progressions in A $\flat$ major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

## Diatonic chords in A $\flat$ major

| I · A $\flat$<br>tonic | ii · B $\flat$ m<br>subdom. | iii · Cm<br>linking | IV · D $\flat$<br>subdom. | V · E $\flat$<br>dominant | vi · Fm<br>rel. minor | vii $^\circ$ · Gdim<br>side                                        |
|------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------|---------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4                      | x                           | x                   | 9                         | x                         | 6                     |                                                                    |
| A $\flat$<br>I · tonic | B $\flat$ m<br>ii · subdom. | Cm<br>iii · linking | D $\flat$<br>IV · subdom. | E $\flat$<br>V · dominant | Fm<br>vi · rel. minor | Gdim<br>vii $^\circ$ · skip it<br>pull substitute:<br>G7<br>320001 |

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in A $\flat$ major)

I - IV - V

A $\flat$  - D $\flat$  - E $\flat$

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

A $\flat$  - E $\flat$  - Fm - D $\flat$

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

Fm - D $\flat$  - A $\flat$  - E $\flat$

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

A $\flat$  - Fm - D $\flat$  - E $\flat$

doo-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

B $\flat$ m - E $\flat$  - A $\flat$

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

|             |             |             |             |             |             |             |             |             |             |             |             |
|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|
| A $\flat$ 7 | A $\flat$ 7 | A $\flat$ 7 | A $\flat$ 7 | D $\flat$ 7 | D $\flat$ 7 | A $\flat$ 7 | A $\flat$ 7 | E $\flat$ 7 | D $\flat$ 7 | A $\flat$ 7 | E $\flat$ 7 |
|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10

tonic on string 6

A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8

tonic on string 5

Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10

tonic on string 6

Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8

tonic on string 5

### The easiest way — the key of A $\flat$ :

capo 1 + G major shapes

A $\flat$ , B $\flat$ m, Cm, D $\flat$ , E $\flat$ , Fm — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

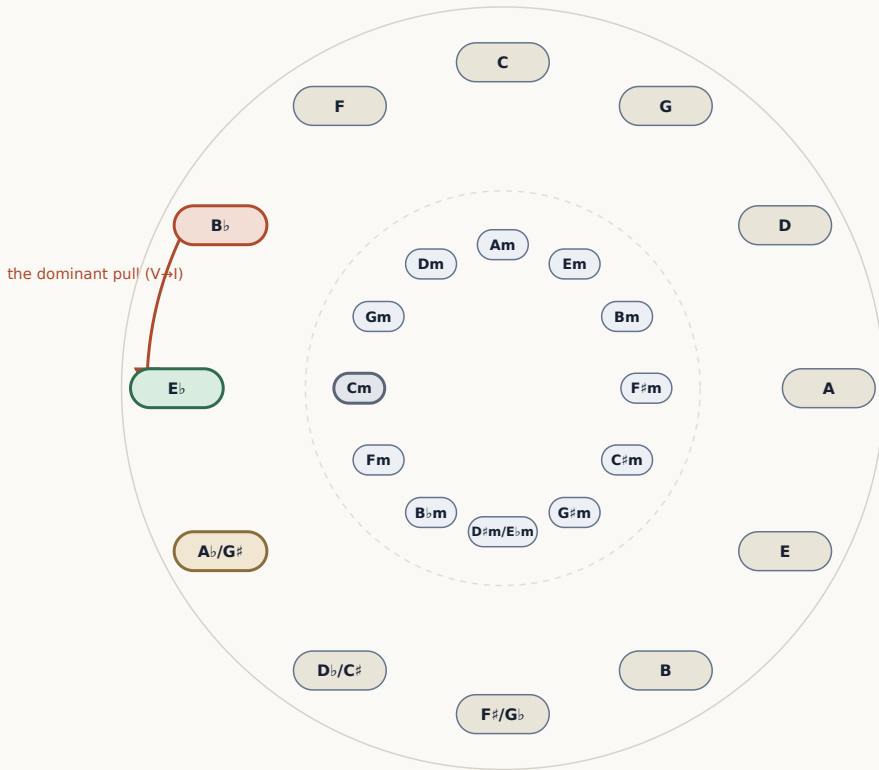
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: I tonic · IV subdominant · V dominant · vi rel. minor

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

# Chord progressions in E<sub>b</sub> major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

## Diatonic chords in E<sub>b</sub> major

| I · E <sub>b</sub><br>tonic | ii · Fm<br>subdom. | iii · Gm<br>linking | IV · A <sub>b</sub><br>subdom. | V · B <sub>b</sub><br>dominant | vi · Cm<br>rel. minor | vii° · Ddim<br>side |
|-----------------------------|--------------------|---------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------|---------------------|
| x                           |                    |                     |                                | x                              | x                     |                     |
| 6                           |                    | 3                   | 4                              |                                | 3                     |                     |
|                             |                    |                     |                                |                                |                       |                     |
| E <sub>b</sub><br>I · tonic | Fm<br>ii · subdom. | Gm<br>iii · linking | A <sub>b</sub><br>IV · subdom. | B <sub>b</sub><br>V · dominant | Cm<br>vi · rel. minor |                     |

**Ddim**  
vii° · skip it  
pull substitute:  
**D7**  
xx0212

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in E<sub>b</sub> major)

**I - IV - V**

**E<sub>b</sub> - A<sub>b</sub> - B<sub>b</sub>**

the staple of rock and folk

**I - V - vi - IV**

**E<sub>b</sub> - B<sub>b</sub> - Cm - A<sub>b</sub>**

the pop "four-chord"

**vi - IV - I - V**

**Cm - A<sub>b</sub> - E<sub>b</sub> - B<sub>b</sub>**

the same four chords, but home in the minor

**I - vi - IV - V**

**E<sub>b</sub> - Cm - A<sub>b</sub> - B<sub>b</sub>**

doo-wop, the 1950s

**ii - V - I**

**Fm - B<sub>b</sub> - E<sub>b</sub>**

a jazz turnaround

**Blues, 12 bars:**

|                  |                  |                  |                  |                  |                  |                  |                  |                  |                  |                  |                  |
|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|
| E <sub>b</sub> 7 | E <sub>b</sub> 7 | E <sub>b</sub> 7 | E <sub>b</sub> 7 | A <sub>b</sub> 7 | A <sub>b</sub> 7 | E <sub>b</sub> 7 | E <sub>b</sub> 7 | B <sub>b</sub> 7 | A <sub>b</sub> 7 | E <sub>b</sub> 7 | B <sub>b</sub> 7 |
|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|------------------|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits

**E major shape**  
F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6

**A major shape**  
B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5

**Em minor shape**  
F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6

**Am minor shape**  
Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

### The easiest way — the key of E<sub>b</sub>:

capo 3 + C major shapes

E<sub>b</sub>, Fm, Gm, A<sub>b</sub>, B<sub>b</sub>, Cm — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

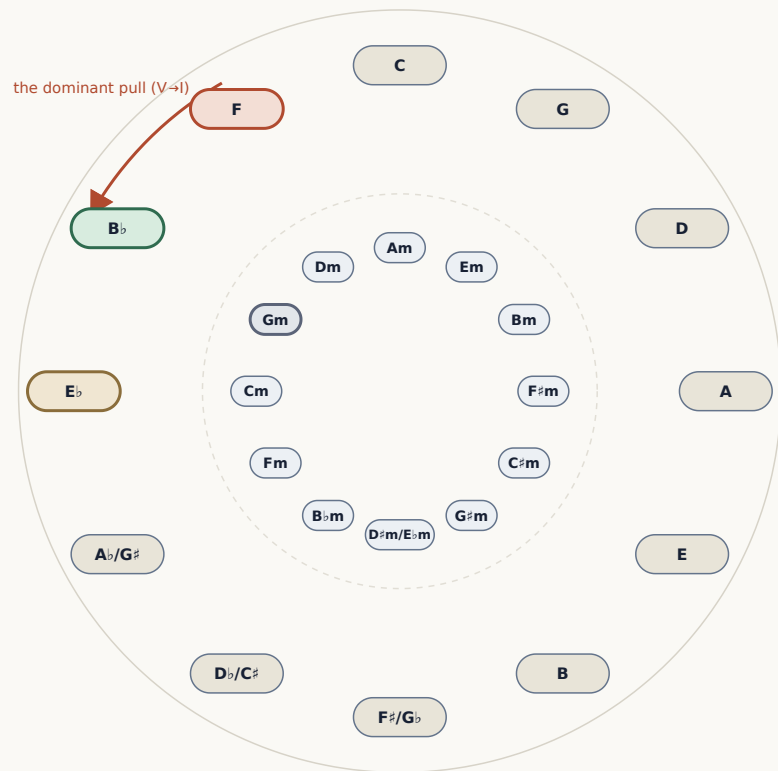
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

# Chord progressions in B $\flat$ major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

## Diatonic chords in B $\flat$ major

| I · B $\flat$<br>tonic | ii · Cm<br>subdom. | iii · Dm<br>linking | IV · E $\flat$<br>subdom. | V · F<br>dominant | vi · Gm<br>rel. minor | vii $^\circ$ · Adim<br>side |
|------------------------|--------------------|---------------------|---------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------------|
| x                      | x                  | x x ○               | x                         |                   |                       |                             |
|                        |                    |                     |                           |                   |                       |                             |
| B $\flat$<br>I · tonic | Cm<br>ii · subdom. | Dm<br>iii · linking | E $\flat$<br>IV · subdom. | F<br>V · dominant | Gm<br>vi · rel. minor |                             |

Adim  
vii $^\circ$  · skip it  
pull substitute:  
**A7**  
x02020

Notation: ○ = open string, x = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in B $\flat$ major)

**I - IV - V**

**B $\flat$  - E $\flat$  - F**

the staple of rock and folk

**I - V - vi - IV**

**B $\flat$  - F - Gm - E $\flat$**

the pop "four-chord"

**vi - IV - I - V**

**Gm - E $\flat$  - B $\flat$  - F**

the same four chords, but home in the minor

**I - vi - IV - V**

**B $\flat$  - Gm - E $\flat$  - F**

doo-wop, the 1950s

**ii - V - I**

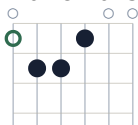
**Cm - F - B $\flat$**

a jazz turnaround

**Blues, 12 bars:**

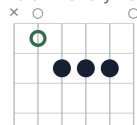
|             |             |             |             |             |             |             |             |    |             |             |    |
|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|----|-------------|-------------|----|
| B $\flat$ 7 | B $\flat$ 7 | B $\flat$ 7 | B $\flat$ 7 | E $\flat$ 7 | E $\flat$ 7 | B $\flat$ 7 | B $\flat$ 7 | F7 | E $\flat$ 7 | B $\flat$ 7 | F7 |
|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|----|-------------|-------------|----|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



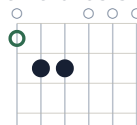
**E major shape**

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



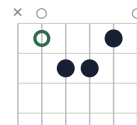
**A major shape**

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



**Em minor shape**

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



**Am minor shape**

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

### The easiest way — the key of B $\flat$ :

capo 1 + A major shapes

B $\flat$ , Cm, Dm, E $\flat$ , F, Gm — easier shapes.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

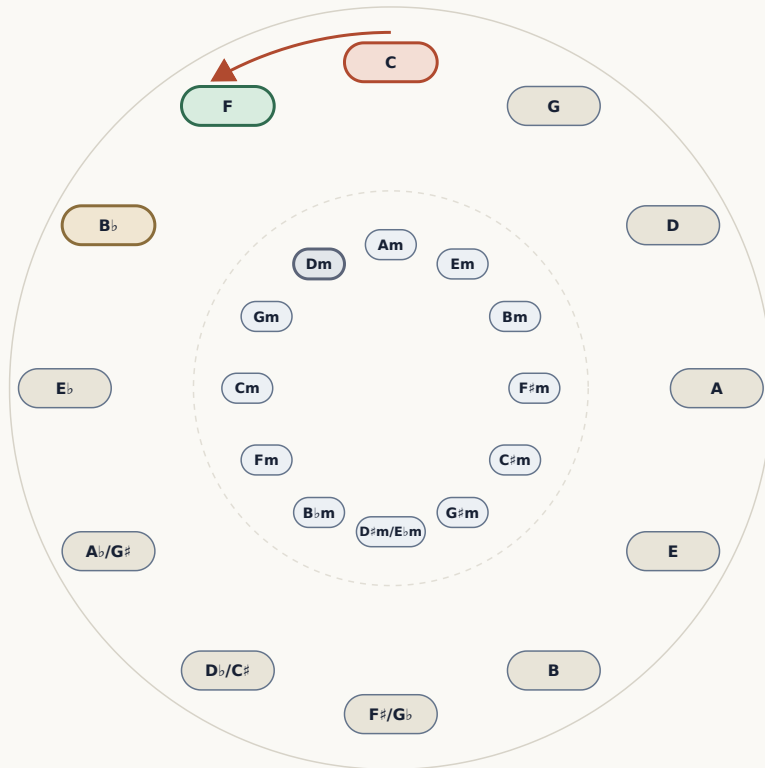
Functions: **I tonic** · **IV subdominant** · **V dominant** · **vi rel. minor**

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

# Chord progressions in F major

Circle of fifths · chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition

the dominant pull (V→I)



Your key = a position on the circle: V (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, IV (subdominant) on the left, vi (the relative minor) sits in the inner ring below the tonic; the highlighted key is marked by colour.

## Diatonic chords in F major

| I · F<br>tonic | ii · Gm<br>subdom. | iii · Am<br>linking | IV · Bb<br>subdom. | V · C<br>dominant | vi · Dm<br>rel. minor | vii° · Edim<br>side                                        |
|----------------|--------------------|---------------------|--------------------|-------------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
|                |                    |                     |                    |                   |                       |                                                            |
| F<br>I · tonic | Gm<br>ii · subdom. | Am<br>iii · linking | Bb<br>IV · subdom. | C<br>V · dominant | Dm<br>vi · rel. minor | Edim<br>vii° · skip it<br>pull substitute:<br>E7<br>020100 |

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in F major)

I - IV - V

F - Bb - C

the staple of rock and folk

I - V - vi - IV

F - C - Dm - Bb

the pop "four-chord"

vi - IV - I - V

Dm - Bb - F - C

the same four chords, but home in the minor

I - vi - IV - V

F - Dm - Bb - C

doo-wop, the 1950s

ii - V - I

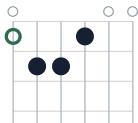
Gm - C - F

a jazz turnaround

Blues, 12 bars:

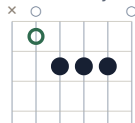
|    |    |    |    |     |     |    |    |    |     |    |    |
|----|----|----|----|-----|-----|----|----|----|-----|----|----|
| F7 | F7 | F7 | F7 | Bb7 | Bb7 | F7 | F7 | C7 | Bb7 | F7 | C7 |
|----|----|----|----|-----|-----|----|----|----|-----|----|----|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



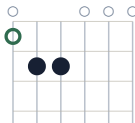
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



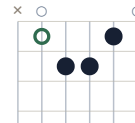
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

### The easiest way — the key of F:

F/Gm/Bb barre, Am/C/D open; otherwise capo 5 + shapes  
C major → F, Gm, Am, Bb, C, Dm.

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

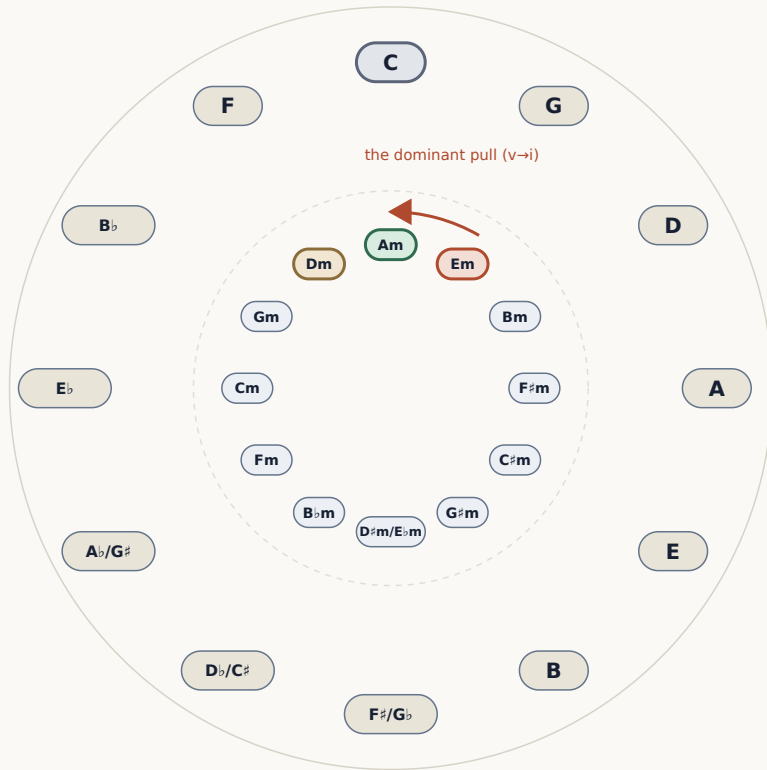
up by N frets — you land in this page's key.

Functions: I tonic · IV subdominant · V dominant · vi rel. minor

The relations hold in every major key — the notes change, not the roles.

# Chord progressions in A minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of A minor is highlighted.

## Diatonic chords in A minor

Functions: **i** · **iv**/VI · **v** · III

| <b>i · Am</b><br>tonic | <b>ii° · Bdim</b><br>side                    | <b>III · C</b><br>rel. major | <b>iv · Dm</b><br>subdom. | <b>v · Em</b><br>minor dom. | <b>VI · F</b><br>subdom. | <b>VII · G</b><br>side |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------|
| Am<br>i · tonic        | Bdim<br>ii° · skip it<br>take iv instead: Dm | C<br>III · rel. major        | Dm<br>iv · subdom.        | Em<br>v · minor dom.        | F<br>VI · subdom.        | G<br>VII · side        |

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)  
shape: 020100

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in A minor)

**i - VI - III - VII**

**Am - F - C - G**

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

**i - iv - V**

**Am - Dm - E7**

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

**i - VII - VI - V**

**Am - G - F - E**

the Andalusian cadence

**i - VII - VI - v**

**Am - G - F - Em**

the softer modal variant

**i - III - VII - VI**

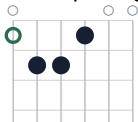
**Am - C - G - F**

the four-chord rotation

**Blues in minor, 12 bars:**

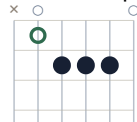
|     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |    |     |     |    |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|----|-----|-----|----|
| Am7 | Am7 | Am7 | Am7 | Dm7 | Dm7 | Am7 | Am7 | E7 | Dm7 | Am7 | E7 |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|----|-----|-----|----|

## Transposing on the guitar: one barre shape, any key



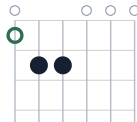
**E major shape**

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



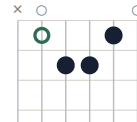
**A major shape**

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



**Em minor shape**

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



**Am minor shape**

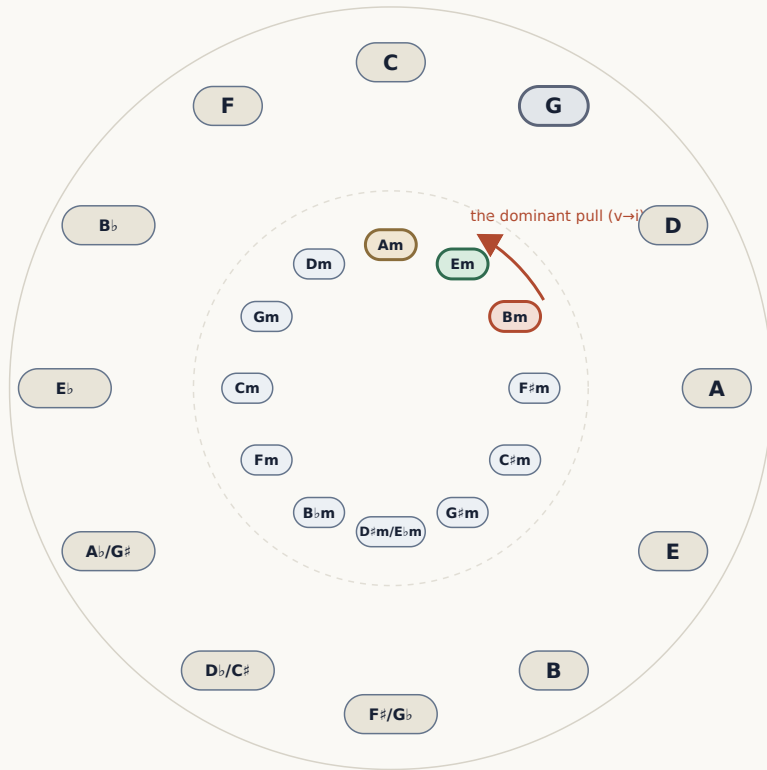
Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

**How to read it: a barre = one finger across all strings,** at the chosen fret — the shape stays, only the position changes. The green ring marks where the tonic sits (the chord's name). Progressions work in EVERY minor key — you shift them along the circle: e.g. a-F-C-G (Am-F-C-G) → E minor: Em-C-G-D.

Functions: **i** tonic · **iv**/VI subdominant · **v** dominant  
**III** the major sibling — the notes change, not the roles.

# Chord progressions in E minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of E minor is highlighted.

## Diatonic chords in E minor

Functions: i · iv/VI · v · III

| i · Em<br>tonic | ii° · F#dim<br>side                          | III · G<br>rel. major | iv · A<br>subdom. | v · Bm<br>minor dom. | VI · C<br>subdom. | VII · D<br>side |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------|----------------------|-------------------|-----------------|
| Em<br>i · tonic | F#dim<br>ii° · skip it<br>take iv instead: A | G<br>III · rel. major | A<br>iv · subdom. | Bm<br>v · minor dom. | C<br>VI · subdom. | D<br>VII · side |

the v7 pull (harmonic minor)  
shape: x21202

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in E minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Em - C - G - D

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Em - A - B7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

Em - D - C - B

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Em - D - C - Bm

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

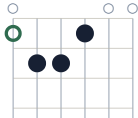
Em - G - D - C

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

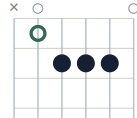
|     |     |     |     |    |    |     |     |    |    |     |    |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|----|----|-----|-----|----|----|-----|----|
| Em7 | Em7 | Em7 | Em7 | A7 | A7 | Em7 | Em7 | B7 | A7 | Em7 | B7 |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|----|----|-----|-----|----|----|-----|----|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



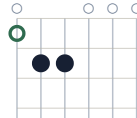
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



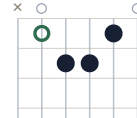
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

## The easiest way — the key of E minor:

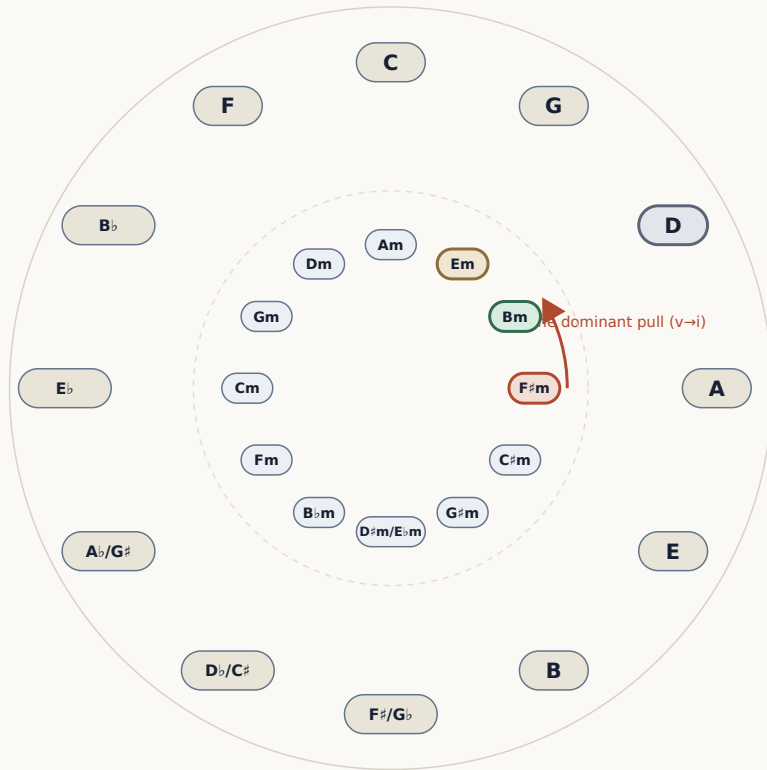
All open shapes except Bm

(barre at fret 2) — otherwise capo 2 + A-minor shapes (Am→Bm, Dm→Em, C→D, G→A, Em→F#m)

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

# Chord progressions in B minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of B minor is highlighted.

## Diatonic chords in B minor

Functions: i · iv/VI · v · III

| i · Bm<br>tonic | ii° · C#dim<br>side                           | III · D<br>rel. major | iv · Em<br>subdom. | v · F#m<br>minor dom. | VI · G<br>subdom. | VII · A<br>side |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------|-----------------------|-------------------|-----------------|
|                 |                                               |                       |                    |                       |                   |                 |
| Bm<br>i · tonic | C#dim<br>ii° · skip it<br>take iv instead: Em | D<br>III · rel. major | Em<br>iv · subdom. | F#m<br>v · minor dom. | G<br>VI · subdom. | A<br>VII · side |

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)  
shape: 242322

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in B minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Bm - G - D - A

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Bm - Em - F#7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

Bm - A - G - F#

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Bm - A - G - F#m

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

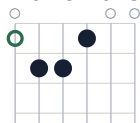
Bm - D - A - G

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

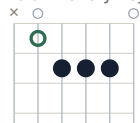
|     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| Bm7 | Bm7 | Bm7 | Bm7 | Em7 | Em7 | Bm7 | Bm7 | F#7 | Em7 | Bm7 | F#7 |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



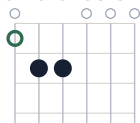
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



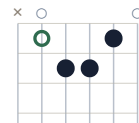
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

## The easiest way — the key of B minor:

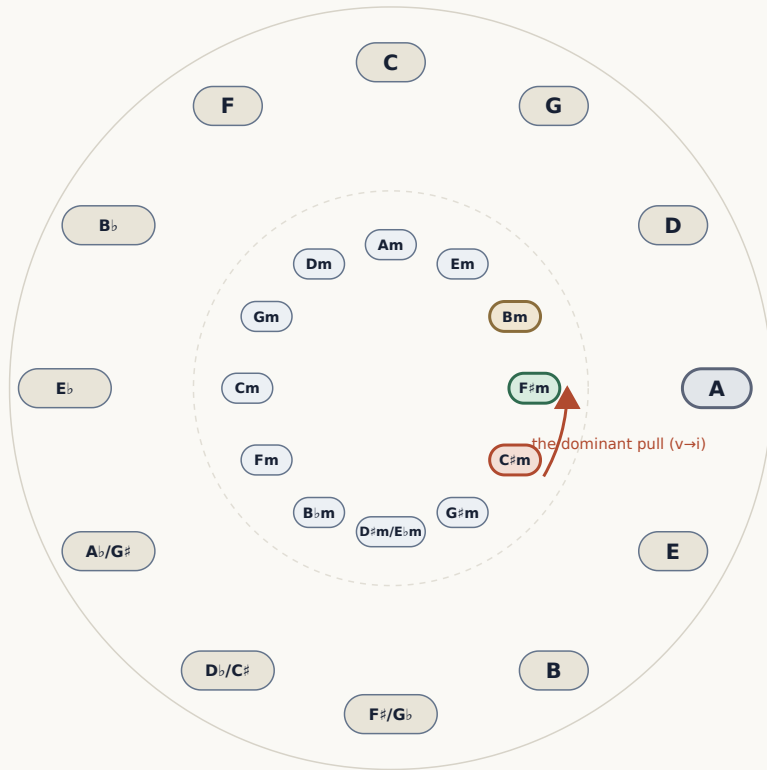
capo 2 + A minor shapes

(Am→Bm, Dm→Em, Em→F#m, F→G, C→D, G→A).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

# Chord progressions in F# minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of F# minor is highlighted.

## Diatonic chords in F# minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

| i · F#m<br>tonic | ii° · G#dim<br>side                          | III · A<br>rel. major | iv · B<br>subdom. | v · C#m<br>minor dom. | VI · D<br>subdom. | VII · E<br>side |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------|-----------------------|-------------------|-----------------|
|                  |                                              |                       |                   |                       |                   |                 |
| F#m<br>i · tonic | G#dim<br>ii° · skip it<br>take iv instead: B | A<br>III · rel. major | B<br>iv · subdom. | C#m<br>v · minor dom. | D<br>VI · subdom. | E<br>VII · side |

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)  
shape: x46464

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in F# minor)

i - VI - III - VII

F#m - D - A - E

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

F#m - B - C#7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

F#m - E - D - C#

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

F#m - E - D - C#m

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

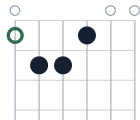
F#m - A - E - D

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

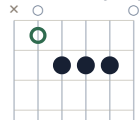
|      |      |      |      |    |    |      |      |     |    |      |     |
|------|------|------|------|----|----|------|------|-----|----|------|-----|
| F#m7 | F#m7 | F#m7 | F#m7 | B7 | B7 | F#m7 | F#m7 | C#7 | B7 | F#m7 | C#7 |
|------|------|------|------|----|----|------|------|-----|----|------|-----|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



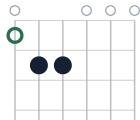
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



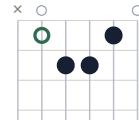
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

## The easiest way — the key of F# minor:

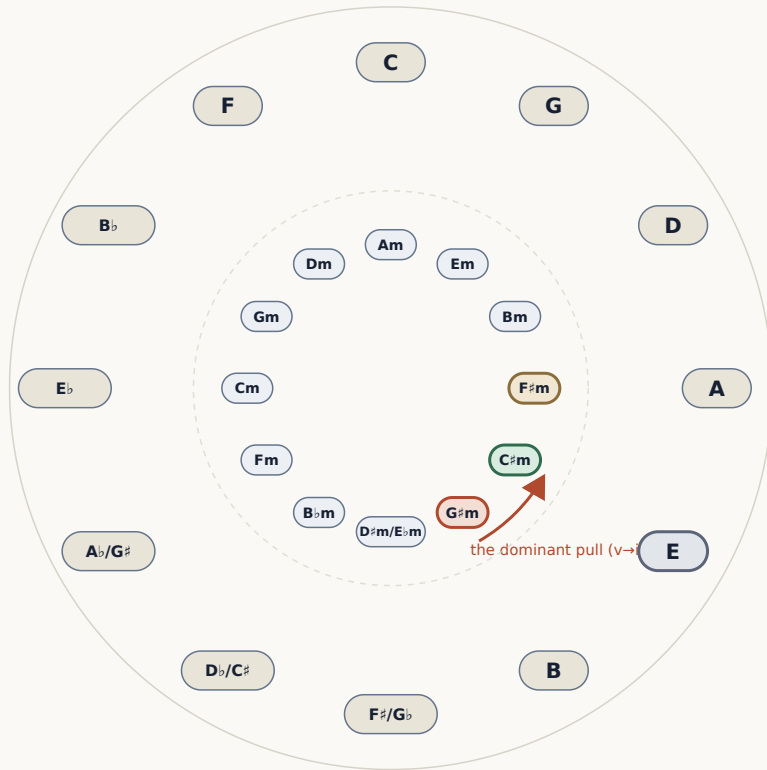
capo 2 + E minor shapes

(Em→F#m, G→A, A→B, Bm→C#m, C→D, D→E).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

# Chord progressions in C# minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of C# minor is highlighted.

## Diatonic chords in C# minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

| i · C#m<br>tonic | ii° · D#dim<br>side                                | III · E<br>rel. major | iv · F#m<br>subdom. | v · G#m<br>minor dom. | VI · A<br>subdom. | VII · B<br>side |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|-------------------|-----------------|
|                  | <br>D#dim<br>ii° · skip it<br>take iv instead: F#m |                       |                     |                       |                   |                 |
| C#m<br>i · tonic |                                                    | E<br>III · rel. major | F#m<br>iv · subdom. | G#m<br>v · minor dom. | A<br>VI · subdom. | B<br>VII · side |

**G#7**  
the V7 pull (harmonic minor)  
shape: 464544

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in C# minor)

i - VI - III - VII

C#m - A - E - B

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

C#m - F#m - G#7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

C#m - B - A - G#

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

C#m - B - A - G#m

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

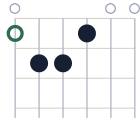
C#m - E - B - A

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

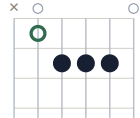
|      |      |      |      |      |      |      |      |     |      |      |     |
|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|-----|------|------|-----|
| C#m7 | C#m7 | C#m7 | C#m7 | F#m7 | F#m7 | C#m7 | C#m7 | G#7 | F#m7 | C#m7 | G#7 |
|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|-----|------|------|-----|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



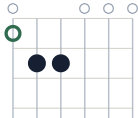
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



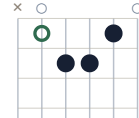
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

## The easiest way — the key of C# minor:

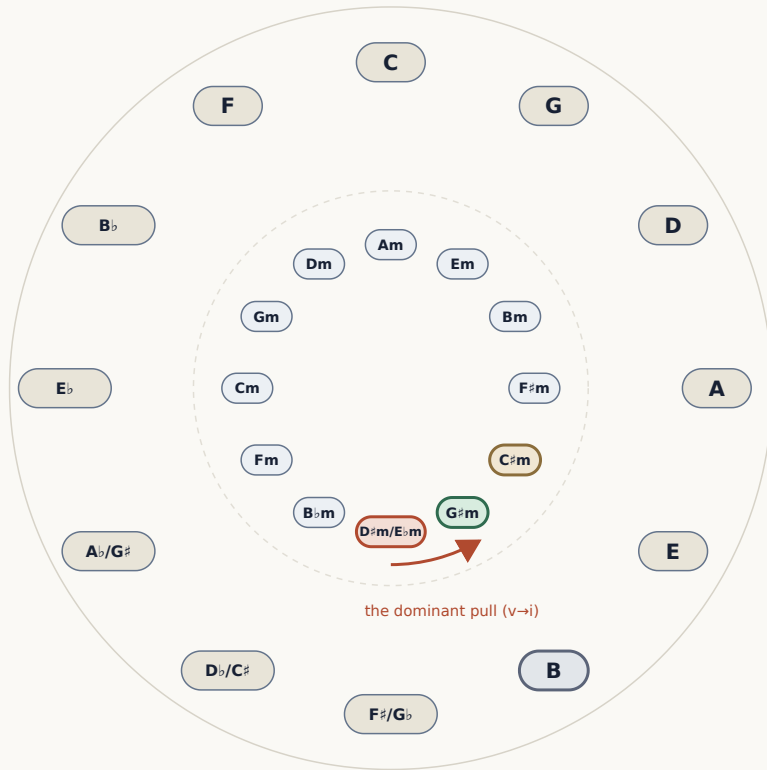
capo 4 + A minor shapes

(Am→C#m, Dm→F#m, Em→G#m, F→A, G→B, C→E).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

# Chord progressions in G# minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of G# minor is highlighted.

## Diatonic chords in G# minor

Functions: i · iv/VI · v · III

| i · G#m<br>tonic | ii° · A#dim<br>side                            | III · B<br>rel. major | iv · C#m<br>subdom. | v · D#m<br>minor dom. | VI · E<br>subdom. | VII · F#<br>side |
|------------------|------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|---------------------|-----------------------|-------------------|------------------|
|                  |                                                |                       |                     |                       |                   |                  |
| G#m<br>i · tonic | A#dim<br>ii° · skip it<br>take iv instead: C#m | B<br>III · rel. major | C#m<br>iv · subdom. | D#m<br>v · minor dom. | E<br>VI · subdom. | F#<br>VII · side |

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)  
shape: x6866

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in G# minor)

i - VI - III - VII

G#m - E - B - F#

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

G#m - C#m - D#7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

G#m - F# - E - D#

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

G#m - F# - E - D#m

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

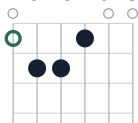
G#m - B - F# - E

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

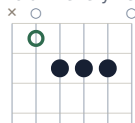
|      |      |      |      |      |      |      |      |     |      |      |     |
|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|-----|------|------|-----|
| G#m7 | G#m7 | G#m7 | G#m7 | C#m7 | C#m7 | G#m7 | G#m7 | D#7 | C#m7 | G#m7 | D#7 |
|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|-----|------|------|-----|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



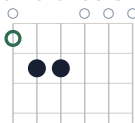
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



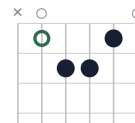
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

## The easiest way — the key of G# minor:

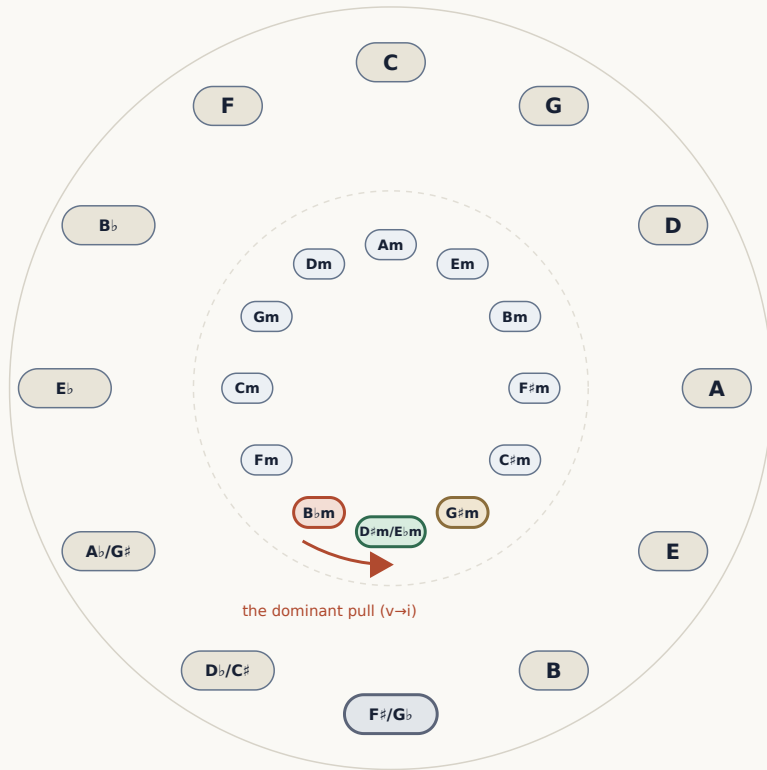
capo 4 + E minor shapes

(Em→G#m, G→B, A→C#, Bm→D#m, C→E, D→F#).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

# Chord progressions in D# minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of D# minor is highlighted.

## Diatonic chords in D# minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

| i · D#m<br>tonic        | ii° · E#dim<br>side                                   | III · F#<br>rel. major        | iv · G#m<br>subdom.        | v · A#m<br>minor dom.        | VI · B<br>subdom.        | VII · C#<br>side        |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------|
|                         |                                                       |                               |                            |                              |                          |                         |
| <b>D#m</b><br>i · tonic | <b>E#dim</b><br>ii° · skip it<br>take iv instead: G#m | <b>F#</b><br>III · rel. major | <b>G#m</b><br>iv · subdom. | <b>A#m</b><br>v · minor dom. | <b>B</b><br>VI · subdom. | <b>C#</b><br>VII · side |

**A#7**  
the V7 pull (harmonic minor)  
shape: x13131

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in D# minor)

i - VI - III - VII

D#m - B - F# - C#

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

D#m - G#m - A#7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

D#m - C# - B - A#

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

D#m - C# - B - A#m

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

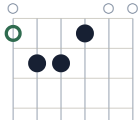
D#m - F# - C# - B

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

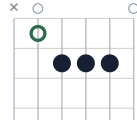
|      |      |      |      |      |      |      |      |     |      |      |     |
|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|-----|------|------|-----|
| D#m7 | D#m7 | D#m7 | D#m7 | G#m7 | G#m7 | D#m7 | D#m7 | A#7 | G#m7 | D#m7 | A#7 |
|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|------|-----|------|------|-----|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



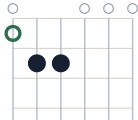
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



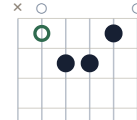
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

## The easiest way — the key of D# minor:

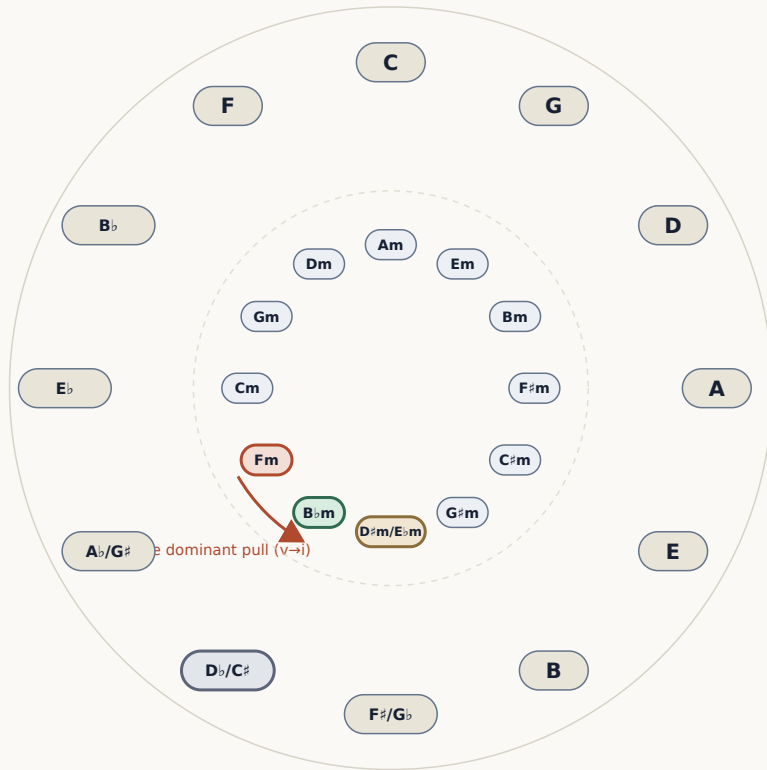
capo 6 + A minor shapes

(Am→D#m, Dm→G#m, Em→A#m, F→B, G→C#, C→F#).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

# Chord progressions in B $\flat$ minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of B $\flat$  minor is highlighted.

## Diatonic chords in B $\flat$ minor

Functions: i · iv/VI · v · III

| i · B $\flat$ m<br>tonic | ii $^\circ$ · Cdim<br>side                                    | III · D $\flat$<br>rel. major | iv · E $\flat$ m<br>subdom. | v · Fm<br>minor dom. | VI · G $\flat$<br>subdom. | VII · A $\flat$<br>side |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------|
|                          |                                                               |                               |                             |                      |                           |                         |
| B $\flat$ m<br>i · tonic | Cdim<br>ii $^\circ$ · skip it<br>take iv instead: E $\flat$ m | D $\flat$<br>III · rel. major | E $\flat$ m<br>iv · subdom. | Fm<br>v · minor dom. | G $\flat$<br>VI · subdom. | A $\flat$<br>VII · side |

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)  
shape: 131211

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in B $\flat$ minor)

i - VI - III - VII

B $\flat$ m - G $\flat$  - D $\flat$  - A $\flat$

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

B $\flat$ m - E $\flat$ m - F7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

B $\flat$ m - A $\flat$  - G $\flat$  - F

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

B $\flat$ m - A $\flat$  - G $\flat$  - Fm

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

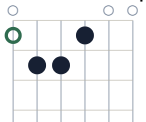
B $\flat$ m - D $\flat$  - A $\flat$  - G $\flat$

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

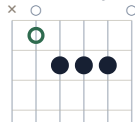
|              |              |              |              |              |              |              |              |    |              |              |    |
|--------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|----|--------------|--------------|----|
| B $\flat$ m7 | B $\flat$ m7 | B $\flat$ m7 | B $\flat$ m7 | E $\flat$ m7 | E $\flat$ m7 | B $\flat$ m7 | B $\flat$ m7 | F7 | E $\flat$ m7 | B $\flat$ m7 | F7 |
|--------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|----|--------------|--------------|----|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



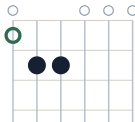
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



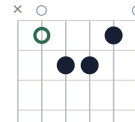
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

## The easiest way — the key of B $\flat$ minor:

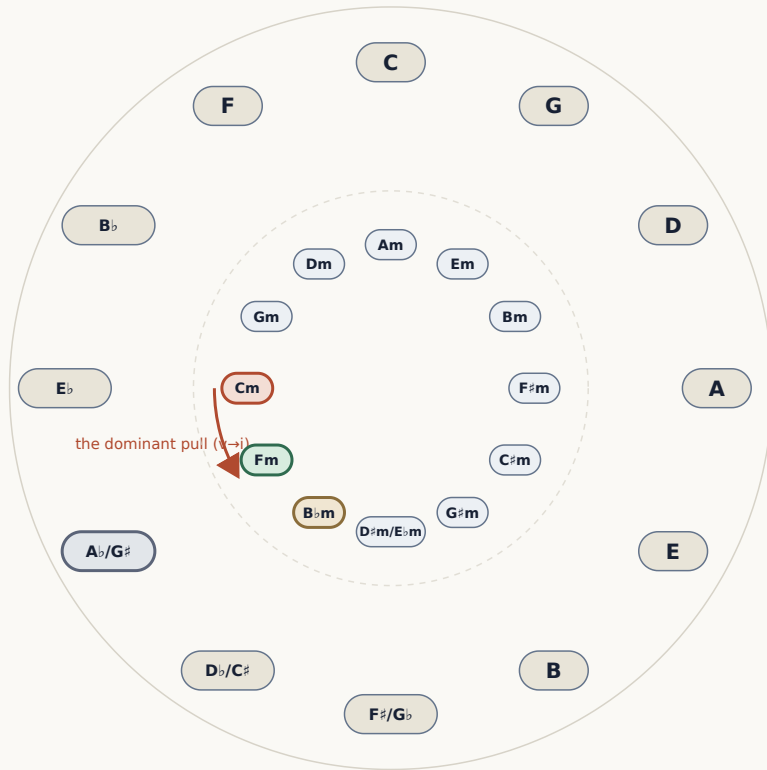
capo 1 + A minor shapes

(Am→B $\flat$ m, Dm→E $\flat$ m, Em→Fm, F→G $\flat$ , G→A $\flat$ , C→D $\flat$ ).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

# Chord progressions in F minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of F minor is highlighted.

## Diatonic chords in F minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

| i · Fm<br>tonic | ii° · Gdim<br>side                            | III · Ab<br>rel. major | iv · Bbm<br>subdom. | v · Cm<br>minor dom. | VI · Db<br>subdom. | VII · Eb<br>side |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------|---------------------|----------------------|--------------------|------------------|
|                 |                                               |                        |                     |                      |                    |                  |
| Fm<br>i · tonic | Gdim<br>ii° · skip it<br>take iv instead: Bbm | Ab<br>III · rel. major | Bbm<br>iv · subdom. | Cm<br>v · minor dom. | Db<br>VI · subdom. | Eb<br>VII · side |

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)  
shape: x32310

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in F minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Fm - Db - Ab - Eb

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Fm - Bbm - Cm

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

Fm - Eb - Db - C

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Fm - Eb - Db - Cm

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

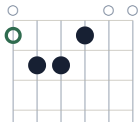
Fm - Ab - Eb - Db

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

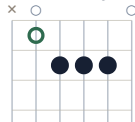
|     |     |     |     |      |      |     |     |    |      |     |    |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|------|------|-----|-----|----|------|-----|----|
| Fm7 | Fm7 | Fm7 | Fm7 | Bbm7 | Bbm7 | Fm7 | Fm7 | C7 | Bbm7 | Fm7 | C7 |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|------|------|-----|-----|----|------|-----|----|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



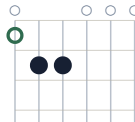
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



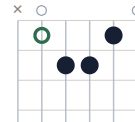
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

Fbm=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

## The easiest way — the key of F minor:

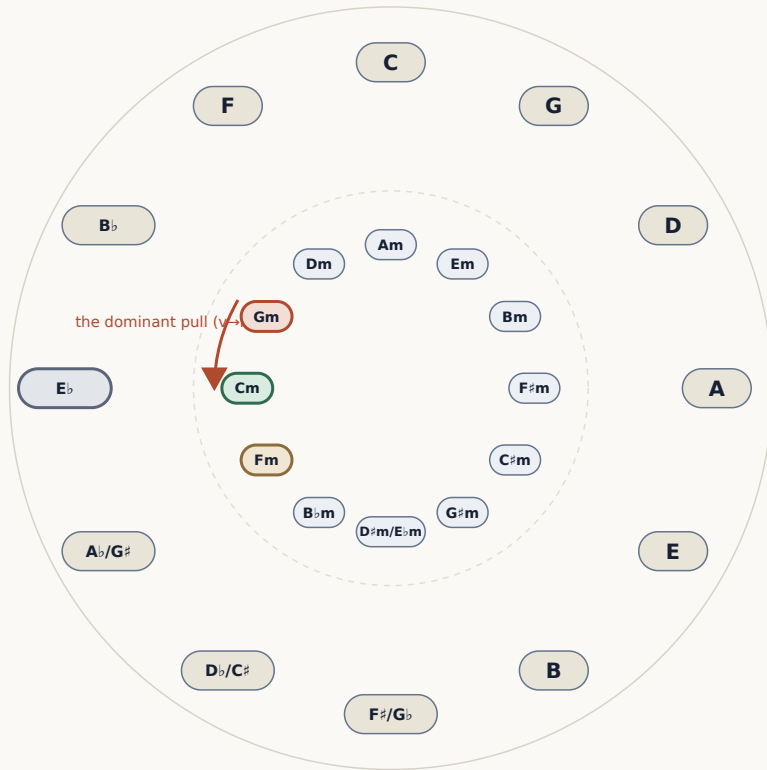
capo 1 + E minor shapes

(Em→Fm, G→Ab, A→Bb, Bm→Cm, C→Db, D→Eb).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

# Chord progressions in C minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of C minor is highlighted.

## Diatonic chords in C minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

| i · Cm<br>tonic | ii° · Ddim<br>side                   | III · Eb<br>rel. major | iv · Fm<br>subdom. | v · Gm<br>minor dom. | VI · Ab<br>subdom. | VII · Bb<br>side |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------|------------------------|--------------------|----------------------|--------------------|------------------|
|                 |                                      |                        |                    |                      |                    |                  |
| i · tonic       | ii° · skip it<br>take iv instead: Fm | III · rel. major       | iv · subdom.       | v · minor dom.       | VI · subdom.       | VII · side       |

the V7 pull (harmonic minor)  
shape: 320001

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in C minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Cm - Ab - Eb - Bb

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Cm - Fm - G7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

Cm - Bb - Ab - G

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Cm - Bb - Ab - Gm

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

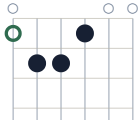
Cm - Eb - Bb - Ab

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

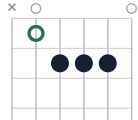
|     |     |     |     |     |     |     |     |    |     |     |    |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|----|-----|-----|----|
| Cm7 | Cm7 | Cm7 | Cm7 | Fm7 | Fm7 | Cm7 | Cm7 | G7 | Fm7 | Cm7 | G7 |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|----|-----|-----|----|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



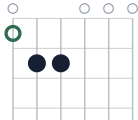
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



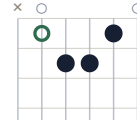
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

## The easiest way — the key of C minor:

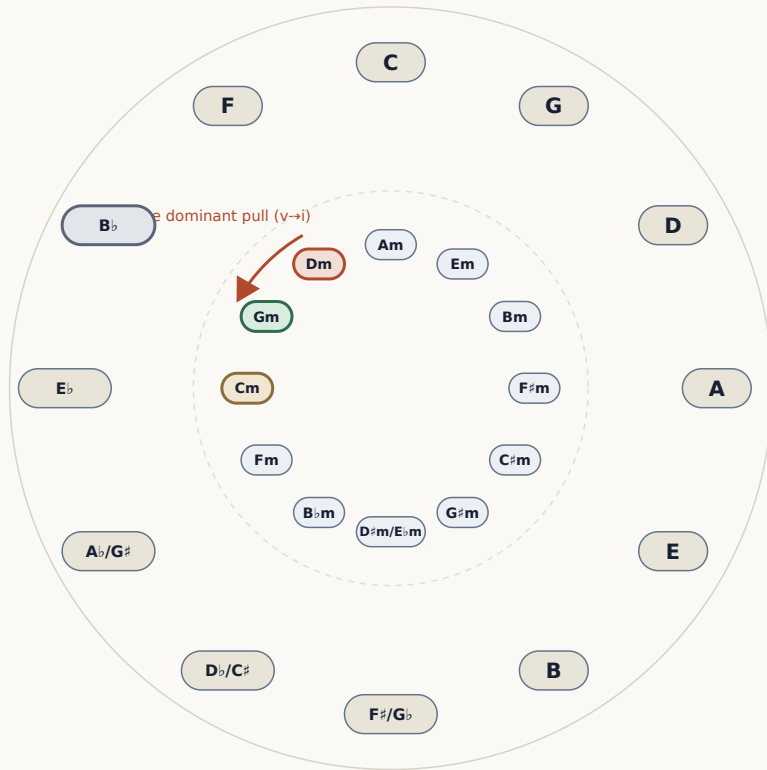
capo 3 + A minor shapes

(Am→Cm, Dm→Fm, Em→Gm, F→Ab, G→Bb, C→Eb).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

# Chord progressions in G minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of G minor is highlighted.

## Diatonic chords in G minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

| i · Gm<br>tonic | ii° · Adim<br>side                  | III · Bb<br>rel. major | iv · C<br>subdom. | v · Dm<br>minor dom. | VI · Eb<br>subdom. | VII · F<br>side |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------|------------------------|-------------------|----------------------|--------------------|-----------------|
|                 |                                     |                        |                   |                      |                    |                 |
| i · tonic       | ii° · skip it<br>take iv instead: C | III · rel. major       | iv · subdom.      | v · minor dom.       | VI · subdom.       | VII · side      |

**D7**  
the V7 pull (harmonic minor)  
shape: xx0212

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in G minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Gm - Eb - Bb - F

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Gm - C - D7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - v

Gm - F - Eb - D

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Gm - F - Eb - Dm

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

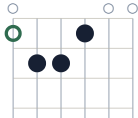
Gm - Bb - F - Eb

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

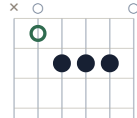
|     |     |     |     |    |    |     |     |    |    |     |    |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|----|----|-----|-----|----|----|-----|----|
| Gm7 | Gm7 | Gm7 | Gm7 | C7 | C7 | Gm7 | Gm7 | D7 | C7 | Gm7 | D7 |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|----|----|-----|-----|----|----|-----|----|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



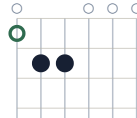
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



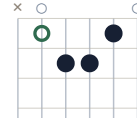
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F#m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

## The easiest way — the key of G minor:

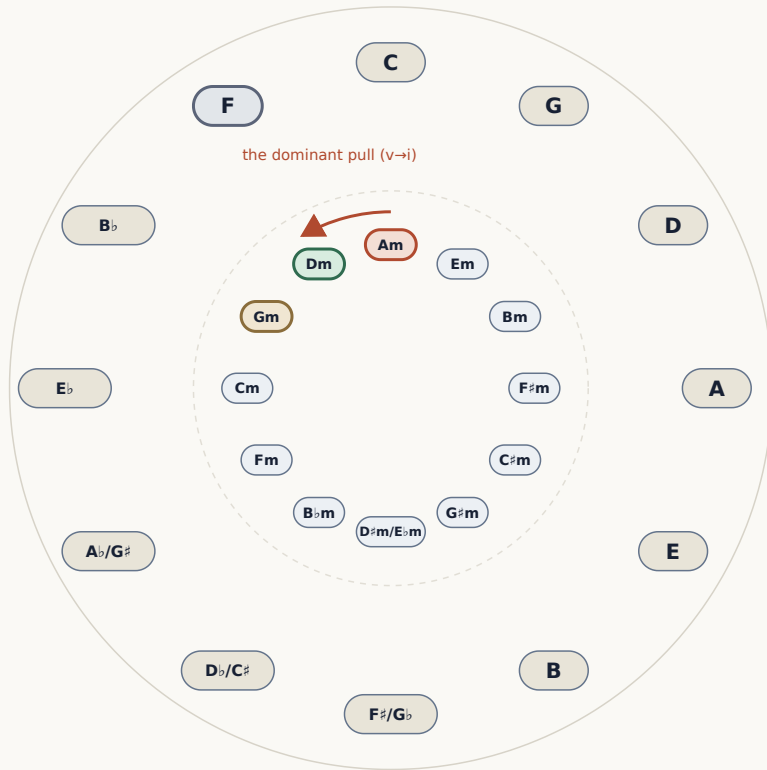
capo 3 + E minor shapes

(Em→Gm, G→Bb, A→C, Bm→Dm, C→Eb, D→F).

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes

# Chord progressions in D minor

Circle of fifths · minor-key chord functions · proven progressions · barre transposition



Your minor key = the inner chip: v (dominant) = the clockwise neighbour, iv (subdominant) on the left, the major sibling (III) sits above the tonic in the outer ring; the key of D minor is highlighted.

## Diatonic chords in D minor

Functions: i · iv/vi · v · III

| i · Dm<br>tonic | ii° · Edim<br>side                          | III · F<br>rel. major | iv · G<br>subdom. | v · Am<br>minor dom. | VI · B $\flat$<br>subdom. | VII · C<br>side |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------|-------------------|----------------------|---------------------------|-----------------|
| x x ○           | ○ ○ ○                                       | ○ ○ ○                 | x ○               | ○ x                  | x ○                       | ○               |
|                 |                                             |                       |                   |                      |                           |                 |
| Dm<br>i · tonic | Edim<br>ii° · skip it<br>take iv instead: G | F<br>III · rel. major | G<br>iv · subdom. | Am<br>v · minor dom. | B $\flat$<br>VI · subdom. | C<br>VII · side |

**A7**  
the V7 pull (harmonic minor)  
shape: x02020

Notation: ○ = open string, × = don't pluck, dot = a fingertip; the left number = the fret where a barre shape starts.

## Proven progressions (in D minor)

i - VI - III - VII

Dm - B $\flat$  - F - C

the pop four-chord, home in the minor

i - iv - V

Dm - G - A7

the harmonic pull (raised 7th)

i - VII - VI - V

Dm - C - B $\flat$  - A

the Andalusian cadence

i - VII - VI - v

Dm - C - B $\flat$  - Am

the softer modal variant

i - III - VII - VI

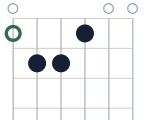
Dm - F - C - B $\flat$

the four-chord rotation

Blues in minor, 12 bars:

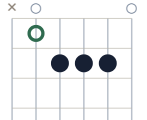
|     |     |     |     |    |    |     |     |    |    |     |    |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|----|----|-----|-----|----|----|-----|----|
| Dm7 | Dm7 | Dm7 | Dm7 | G7 | G7 | Dm7 | Dm7 | A7 | G7 | Dm7 | A7 |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|----|----|-----|-----|----|----|-----|----|

## Barre transposition — the shapes hold in every key; the key = the fret where the tonic sits



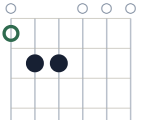
E major shape

F=1 · G=3 · A=5 · B=7 · C=8 · D=10  
tonic on string 6



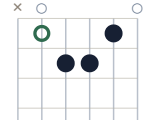
A major shape

B=2 · C=3 · D=5 · E=7 · F=8  
tonic on string 5



Em minor shape

F $\sharp$ m=2 · Gm=3 · Am=5 · Bm=7 · Dm=10  
tonic on string 6



Am minor shape

Bm=2 · Cm=3 · Dm=5 · Em=7 · Fm=8  
tonic on string 5

## The easiest way — the key of D minor:

No capo — Dm/F/G/Am/B $\flat$ /C mostly open shapes; otherwise capo 5 + A-minor shapes (Am→Dm)

Capo = the clamp: it shifts the easy-key shapes